

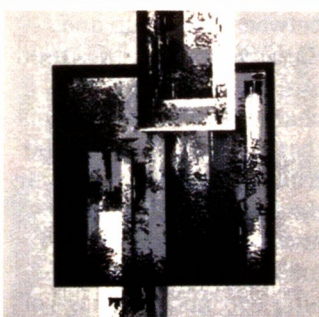
art Varied Mix

MUMBAI Abstracts are beautiful in their own way: they can be interpreted in different ways by different people. Each sighting adds a fresh perspective, a new angle which one had missed earlier. In Abstracts, curator Pravina Mecklai has chosen six artists—Antonio E. Costa, Krishna Pulkundwar, Pandurang Tathe, Ravi Mandlik, Shrikant Kadam and Sudhir Talmale—who have different styles of working with abstract. While Costa, who has travelled across the world, shows unmatched sophistication in his works, Pulkundwar's abstracts are inspired by nature—ravaged walls shown in delightful textures, tree trunks and leaves seen in relief and stark contrasts shown in greys, blacks and whites. Mandlik has worked on striking creations with



DIFFERENT HUES: (Clockwise from top left) Works of Costa, Tathe, Talmale and Pulkundwar

contrasting elements and has graduated from being a landscape artist to a pure abstractionist. So as Tathe dabbles in strong, monochromatic colour palettes in reds and ochres, Kadam uses intriguing forms and colours in his compositions, and Talmale, a Nagpur-based artist, treats

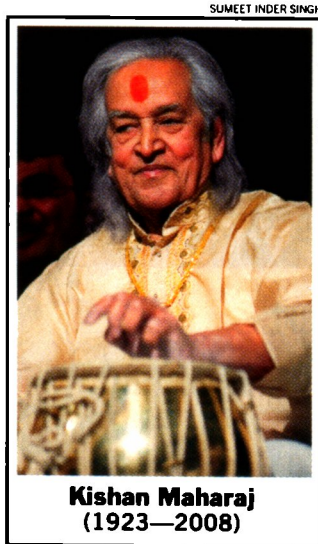


colours with a twist—using deep tones interspersed with flashes of white—dividing the canvas brilliantly and bringing into sharp focus the hues of blue that are so difficult to find. Abstracts is available for view at Jamaat till June 1.

by Swati Mathur

obituary Drums Divine

In the pantheon of Indian classical instrumentalists, Pandit Kishan Maharaj ranks with the best. He was the undisputed master of tabla, gifted with a unique sense of humility and earthiness which added an extra dimension to his talent. Coming from an illustrious family of musicians, Kishan Maharaj started playing the tabla at the age of 11. After the passing away of his father, Pandit Hari Maharaj, his uncle, Pandit Kanthe Maharaj, a disciple of Pandit Baldeo Sahai, took him under his wings. Kishan Maharaj was a



Kishan Maharaj
(1923—2008)

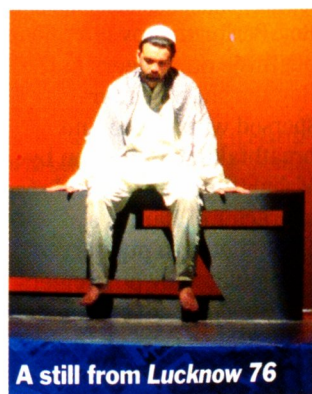
master of rhythm and tempo which allowed him to play complex notes which have now become the leitmotif of the Benaras gharana. His art went beyond music. At a time

when accompanists were given a raw deal, he fought for their status. Despite his own exalted reputation, he never tried to overshadow the main artist at concerts. "One should know one's role as an accompanist and should avoid making the stage a boxing ring," he would say. As a teacher, he shared whatever he learnt with his students. His legacy lives on through students like Kumar Bose, Sukhwinder Singh Namdhari, Balakrishna Iyer and Sandeep Das. He was not only a musician but also a painter and sculptor. With his death at the age of 85, an era of old world music has come to an end.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

recommendations Moving Images

BANGALORE *Lucknow 76* is a performance that traverses 100 years in the history of India—from 1876 when power passed from the East India Company to the Crown to 1976, a year after Indira Gandhi declared the Emergency. Directed by Abhishek Majumdar and devised by an ensemble of actors, the play looks at the life of the common man in the historic city of Lucknow. Supported by the British Library in



A still from *Lucknow 76*

London and Kathalaya and Black Coffee Productions in Bangalore, the play will be performed at Ranga Shankara on May 18.

BANGALORE *Geometry in Life through Dance*, a modern dance presentation, choreographed by Arati Punwani-Sunawala is a compilation of dance vignettes, named after ordinary geometrical shapes, to communicate ideas and stories ranging from episodes that deal with peer pressure to politics and marriage. The show is performed by dancers using a variety of styles and forms. From May 15 till May 17 at Alliance Française.

by Nirmala Ravindran